



CHAITANYA

2026



CodeForge

Official Participant Rulebook

Event Type:

Team Event (2–4 members per Team)

Build Window:

30 Oct, 4:00 PM → 31 Oct, 4:00 PM (24-Hour Clock)

Description:

Chaitanya Hackathon is an intensive 24-hour innovation challenge uniting student developers, designers, and problem solvers to build functional prototypes. Participants collaborate under real-time constraints, demonstrating technical implementation, creativity, and end-to-end execution. Each team must nominate one Team Leader for official communication.

Official Hackathon Timeline:

- 30 Oct, 3:00–3:30 PM: Opening ceremony, rules, and problem statement briefing
- 30 Oct, 3:30–4:00 PM: Mentor interaction & idea validation
- 30 Oct, 4:00 PM: OFFICIAL HACKATHON START (24-hour build clock begins)
- 30 Oct, 5:30–6:30 PM: Progress Review Round 1 (idea, scope, and plan)
- 30 Oct, 8:30–9:30 PM: Dinner break
- 31 Oct, 8:00–9:30 AM: Breakfast break
- 31 Oct, 11:00 AM–12:00 PM: Final Progress Review (testing and demo readiness)
- 31 Oct, 1:00–2:00 PM: Lunch break
- 31 Oct, 4:00 PM: OFFICIAL END — Code Freeze & Final Submission Deadline
- 31 Oct, 4:00 PM onwards: Final presentations, live demonstrations, and judging

Contacts:

Event Coordinators & Contact:

Coordinator 1: Ankita Thakur (+91 9816229682)

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Technology, Open-Source & AI Policy:

- **Technology Stack:** Any programming language, framework, platform, tool, or technology may be used without restriction.
- **Open-Source Components:** Open-source libraries and external resources are permitted. Teams are responsible for applicable licenses and attribution.
- **AI Assistance:** AI-assisted development tools and services may be used, provided teams understand and can explain their submitted solution.
- **Original Work:** Meaningful implementation of the submitted solution must be completed during the hackathon. Previously completed projects cannot be submitted.

Mentorship & Progress Reviews:

- Mentors advise teams on problem definition, feasibility, architecture, technology choices, and product direction.
- Mentors provide guidance and feedback; they do not build the project for the team.
- Progress reviews ensure every team receives mentor attention and discusses blockers. Reviews do not replace final judging.

Submission Rules:

- **Deadline:** Final submission deadline is 31 October at 4:00 PM (Submission / Code Freeze).
- **Deliverables:** Submissions must include team details, problem statement, solution overview, key features, technology stack, source-code repository (Git), and live demo/deployment link where applicable.
- **Late Submissions:** Late submissions may be penalized or rejected at the discretion of the organizing committee.



Evaluation & Judging Criteria:

- Technical Implementation: 25% (Highest Weightage)
 - Innovation & Creativity: 20%
 - Functionality & Working Prototype: 20%
 - Problem Relevance & Understanding: 15%
 - UI/UX & User Experience: 10%
 - Presentation & Demonstration: 10%
- Total: 100%

Final Presentation & Live Demo:

- Presentation starts after the 4:00 PM submission deadline so teams do not build and present simultaneously.
- Recommended Format: 3–5 minutes presentation + live demo + Q&A.
- Structure: Teams should clearly explain problem definition, solution, key features, technology choices, implementation, and future scope. Judges may question architecture, scalability, security, and individual contributions.
- Respectful Conduct: Treat participants, mentors, judges, organizers, and volunteers with respect. Harassment, discrimination, plagiarism, cheating, or tampering with other teams' work is strictly prohibited.
- Backups & Version Control: Teams must use Git/version control and maintain backups. Organizers are not responsible for data loss from device or connectivity failures.
- Organizer's Decision: The organizing committee reserves the right to address situations not explicitly covered. Decisions regarding rule violations are final and binding.